

The Complete Plasma Donation Tax Guide 2026

Plasma Pay Calculator — plasmapaycalculator.com

How Plasma Income Is Taxed

Plasma donation income is **taxable income** reported on your federal return. While you may not receive a 1099, you are legally required to report all plasma earnings.

- **Self-employment income** — reported on Schedule C
- **Subject to self-employment tax** (15.3% for Social Security + Medicare)
- **Subject to federal income tax** at your bracket rate
- **Subject to state income tax** (varies by state, 0-13%)

Key Insight: The good news is you can deduct mileage, supplies, and other expenses to significantly reduce what you owe.

Reporting Step-by-Step

1. Track all plasma income throughout the year (use the Donation Tracker spreadsheet)
2. Track all deductions (mileage, supplies, etc.)
3. File Schedule C (Profit or Loss from Business) with your 1040
4. File Schedule SE (Self-Employment Tax)
5. Pay quarterly estimated taxes if you owe \$1,000+ for the year

Tax Bracket Quick Reference (2026)

Taxable Income (Single)	Rate	Plasma Income Example
\$0 - \$11,925	10%	\$3,000 plasma = \$300 federal tax
\$11,926 - \$48,475	12%	\$3,000 plasma = \$360 federal tax
\$48,476 - \$103,350	22%	\$3,000 plasma = \$660 federal tax
\$103,351 - \$197,300	24%	\$3,000 plasma = \$720 federal tax

Quarterly Estimated Taxes

Quarter	Period	Due Date
Q1	January - March	April 15, 2026
Q2	April - June	June 15, 2026
Q3	July - September	September 15, 2026
Q4	October - December	January 15, 2027

Use the Quarterly Tax Estimator tab in the Mileage & Tax Log spreadsheet to calculate your payments.

State-Specific Notes

- **No state tax:** TX, FL, NV, WA, WY, TN, SD, NH, AK
- **Low tax states:** AZ (2.5%), CO (4.4%), IN (3.05%), NC (4.5%)
- **High tax states:** CA (up to 13.3%), NY (up to 10.9%), NJ (up to 10.75%)

Pro Tip: If you earn \$3,000/year from plasma and drive 2,000 miles to centers, your mileage deduction alone (\$1,400) cuts your taxable income nearly in half. Keep a **mileage log book** in your car and store tax documents in a **fireproof document bag**.

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